

THEATRE

All Kinds of Everything

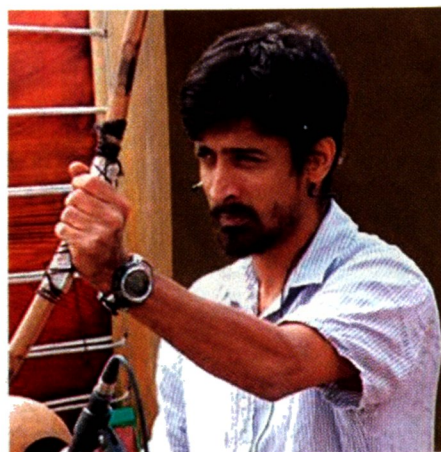
Vulnerable and ferocious Maya Krishna Rao gyrating amidst multi-media art, Naya Theatre without Habib Tanvir, Ratan Thiyam's spectacular take on Ibsen. Everything from Sanskrit classics to modern whodunits. And many new stars. All this and more awaits the audience at the 12th edition of the Bharat Rang Mahotsav, the annual theatre festival of the National School of Drama in Delhi. Starting on January 6, there are 75 plays, of which 12 are productions from abroad. Here is a list of people to watch out for.



◀ **Mohit Takalkar 31, Director** Aasakta founded by Takalkar and his friends in 2002, has earned the reputation of being an experimental theatre group. Formerly assistant director to Tim Supple on the worldwide tour of *A Midsummer Night's Dream*, Takalkar is currently the recipient of the Charles Wallace Scholarship and is pursuing theatre studies in the UK. He has been directing plays in Marathi, Hindi and English for the past six years, some of which have won awards. In his play *Garbo*, Takalkar brings a certain degree of sophistication to the well-known work written by Mahesh Elkunchwar in 1970. At Sanmukh on January 15.



◀ **MANAV KAUL 35, Writer** Much to his discomfort, Kaul has become the pinup for contemporary theatre in Hindi. A poet, writer and playwright, who has supported himself with small roles in films, he has written seven plays. *Aisa Kehta Hain* is a tale with many sub-stories woven in. There's a crow with an identity crisis, a group of pigeons that make fun of humans as well as break into song and dance Bollywood-style, a one-sided love story, a man on a suicide mission. It's electric. At Sriram Centre on January 19.



▶ **JYOTI DOGRA 37, Actor** Best-known for her roles in films like *Hyderabad Blues* and *Gulaal*, she is a theatre veteran who has worked extensively with Khalid Tyabji and Rehaan Engineer. In *The Doorway*, an exploratory solo performance, Dogra takes on the multiple roles of a writer, performer and director. Using a few spoken works in English and Punjabi, Dogra, through sheer physical energy, gives a riveting performance. The performance is loosely based on "Growtowski's Exercises and Actor's Processes". On January 7 at Bahumukh, NSD.



▲ **SANKAR VENKATESWARAN 30, Director** Originally from Kerala, his first play *Quick Death*, based on a play by Richard Murphet, will be performed at the festival this year. The play has elements of film editing in its rendition of an episode that is explored over 51 scenes. In what looks like a modern setting for a thriller, one woman, two men, gunshots, screams and voiceovers add suspense to the whodunit. At Abhimanch on January 14.

by Nirmala Ravindran